

Event Information:

EventID :
72
Event Time :
Mar, 07, 2021, 05:09 PM
Rule :
SOC135 - Multiple FTP Connection Attempt
Level :
Security Analyst
Source Address :
42.192.84.19
Source Hostname :
Anonymous
Destination Address :
172.16.20.4
Destination Hostname :
gitServer
Username :
www-data
Request URL :
http://172.16.20.4/ftp/webUI.php
User Agent :
Mozilla/5.0 (Windows NT 6.1; Win64; x64) AppleWebKit/537.36 (KHTML, like Gecko)
Chrome/79.0.3945.88 Safari/537.36
Device Action :
Allowed

Analysis Steps:

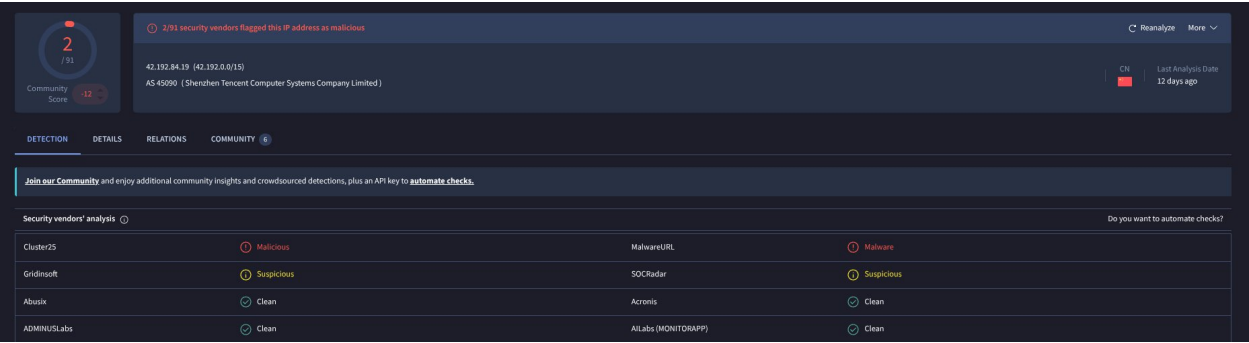
Logs were searched with IP 42[.]192.84.19 as the source in the relevant time-frame yielding 5 events.

✓ 4 events (before Mar, 07, 2021, 05:09 PM UTC)

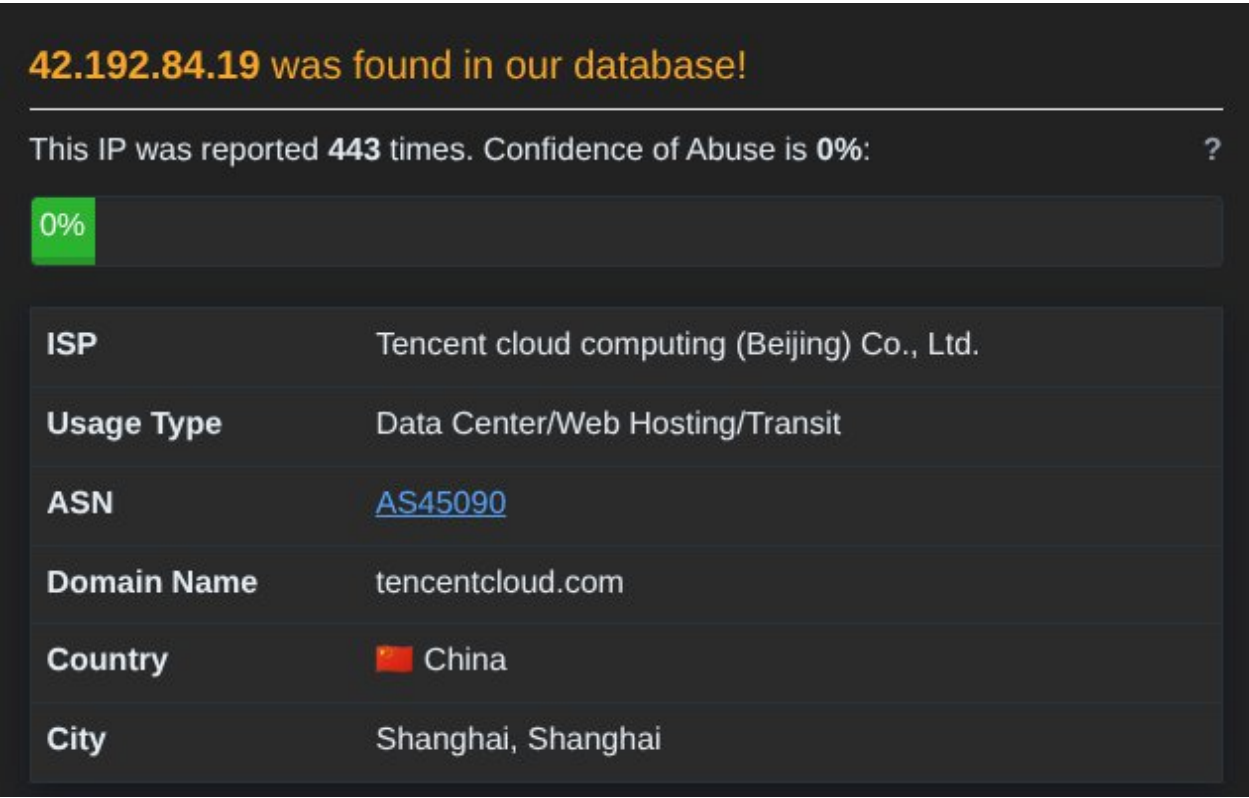
< Hide Fields	🔍 Event
INTERESTING FIELDS	
a type	type Proxy
a source_address	source_address 42.192.84.19
# source_port	source_port 42166
a destination_address	destination_address 172.16.20.4
# destination_port	destination_port 21
a raw_log	time Mar, 07, 2021, 05:09 PM
	Raw Log
	Username admin
	Password admin
	Status Rejected

The attacker can be seen attempting to access FTP with admin privileges by trying different common passwords but all of these were rejected.

The offending IP is not in our CTI database and is external to the organisation. No emails have been received indicating penetration testing involving the IP for the relevant time period. VirusTotal indicates it is a Chinese address associated with 42[.]192.84.19 AS 45090 (Shenzhen Tencent Computer Systems Company Limited). 2/91 security vendors flagged this IP address as malicious as of 12 days ago.



On AbuseIPDB this IP was reported 443 times with a 0% confidence of abuse.



Based on following Playbook procedure and the analysis of available information, this alert is determined to be a failedTrue Positive.

Report:

Incident Summary

Analysis confirms a failed True Positive credential-stuffing and brute-force attack targeting the internal gitServer. An external threat actor attempted to gain unauthorised access by testing common administrative credentials against the server's FTP service. Network logs verify that all authentication attempts were rejected, confirming the attack was entirely unsuccessful.

Incident Details

- **Alert Name:** SOC135 - Multiple FTP Connection Attempt
- **Attacker IP:** 42[.]192.84.19
- **Target Host:** gitServer (172[.]16.20.4)
- **Target Service:** FTP (Port 21)
- **Device Action:** Allowed (Network connection permitted, authentication rejected)

Analysis and Evidence

- **Attack Vector:** The threat actor initiated multiple automated connection requests targeting the FTP service via the web management interface endpoint.
- **Brute-Force Behaviour:** Telemetry logs show the attacker attempting to authenticate using standard default credentials, specifically targeting the username admin with the password admin.
- **Access Status:** The raw logs confirm the authentication status resulted in Rejected for the monitored attempts, proving that the security controls successfully prevented a system breach.

Threat Intelligence

- **Infrastructure OSINT:** The source IP address 42[.]192.84.19 is external to the network and belongs to Tencent Cloud (Shenzhen Tencent Computer Systems Company Limited) operating out of China.
- **IP Reputation:** VirusTotal reports that 2/91 security vendors flag this IP as malicious. AbuseIPDB documents 443 total historical reports for this infrastructure, indicating a persistent pattern of scanning or brute-force activity.
- **Internal Correlation:** Cross-referencing internal security schedules confirmed that no authorised network penetration testing or vulnerability scanning was planned from this external address during the incident window.

Actions Taken

1. Searched and analysed the proxy firewall logs to isolate all connection attempts originating from 42[.]192.84.19.
2. Inspected the raw log authentication payloads to confirm that the threat actor failed to guess valid credentials.
3. Verified the target server's response status remained secure, confirming no unauthorised access was granted.

4. Declared the alert a failed True Positive and closed the ticket, as perimeter defences and authentication controls successfully neutralised the threat.

Let's Defend Result

SOC135 - Multiple FTP Connection Attempt

True Positive (+5 Point)

Has Anyone Accessed IP/URL/Domain? (+5 Point)

Analyze URL Address (+5 Point)